Source: Company Press Release



How can one prompt produce a useful business briefing?

Prompt

ROLE

CONTEXT

TASK

FORMAT

Briefing Memo

What problem are we solving?

3 Hours (180 minutes) - Hour 1 (50 min): Comprehensive Concept Lecture & Live Demonstration - Hour 2 (50 min): Guided Hands-On Lab (Basic Exercise: 4-Box Architecture Form) - Hour 3 (50 min): Applied Business Challenge & Peer Debrief (Advanced Exercise: Competitive Sales Battlecard)

SITUATION

The problem

A vague request often produces a generic, poorly structured memo that takes repeated editing. The user needs a prompt that supplies the role, business context, task, and expected format.

TARGET

Learning goal

Master the 4-part prompt formula to consistently generate executive-ready business deliverables.

Practice material: Use the practice material supplied in the session Markdown.

Use these supplied facts

Do not replace missing information with guesses.

CASE MATERIAL

Public Data Source

- PR Newswire Public Business Press Releases (https://www.prnewswire.com/news-releases/) - Free, real-world corporate product launch announcements and press releases.

BOUNDARY

Use the supplied facts

A vague request often produces a generic, poorly structured memo that takes repeated editing. The user needs a prompt that supplies the role, business context, task, and expected format.

What students need to understand

Key explanations taken from the active session lesson.

CORE IDEA

The Cost of Unstructured Prompts in Business (15 min)

- When employees give ambiguous prompts, ChatGPT generates an "average" response that requires multiple cycles of manual editing. Every cycle wastes valuable business hours. Prompt architecture provides the model with the exact structural boundaries it needs to produce workplace-ready output on the very first try.

CORE IDEA

The 4-Box Prompt Architecture Framework (15 min)

- Teach the 4 modular building blocks:
- Role / Persona: Establishes the authoritative viewpoint, tone, and professional vocabulary (e.g., "Senior Product Marketing Director").
- Business Context: The operational backdrop, target customer, problem being solved, and market conditions.
- Task Directive: An unambiguous command verb stating the exact deliverable (e.g., "Draft a launch announcement memo").
- Output Format Template: The exact schema, headings, bullet counts, and sections required.

What students need to understand

Key explanations taken from the active session lesson.

CORE IDEA

Delimiters and Modular Prompt Design (10 min)

- Why delimiters matter: Using symbols like ###, ---, or """ clearly separates instructions from raw data. This prevents the model from confusing text to analyze with commands to execute, establishing clean prompt hygiene.

CORE IDEA

Instructor Live Demonstration Script & Discussion (10 min)

- Live Demo: Extract 4 facts from a corporate press release on PR Newswire. Type a 4-box modular prompt live on screen into ChatGPT to draft an internal company briefing. Show how defining the Output Format Template ensures the AI never outputs conversational pleasantries like "Sure, here is your email!". Discussion Question: "If you omit the Output Format Template, what default formatting mistakes does ChatGPT typically make?" (Answer: It produces rambling introductory paragraphs, inconsistent bullet points, and excessive sign-offs).

What makes a prompt weak?

These examples come from the current session scenario.

POOR PROMPT 1 - DO NOT USE



A clearer, safer prompt

Keep the source, task, constraints, and output check visible.

IMPROVED PROMPT 1 - COPY AND SEND

AI Chat

You

Role: Senior Product Marketing Director.
Business Context: We are preparing an internal product briefing for our regional sales reps regarding our competitor's new enterprise cloud software announcement.
Task Directive: Extract key competitive facts from the press release delimited below and organize them into an executive briefing memo.

Input Press Release:
###
[Paste PR Newswire text here]
###

Output Format Template:
- Executive Headline: [1 sentence]
- Core Customer Problem Solved: [2 bullets]
- Target Market & Pricing: [1-2 bullets]
- Threat Level & Sales Counter-Arguments: [3 numbered bullets]
Constraint: Do NOT include conversational pleasantries or introductory greetings.

Message AI...

Exercise 1: Follow the steps

Use the complete case and instructions from the session Markdown.

GUIDED PRACTICE

Exercise 1: Follow the steps

- Scenario: Select one recent corporate product launch announcement from the PR Newswire public feed.
- Task: Extract 4 core business facts (company name, product name, customer pain point, target market) and construct a prompt using the 4-Box framework (Role, Context, Task, Format) with delimiters to draft an internal company briefing.
- Deliverable: A 4-box table and the formatted executive memo.

Exercise 2: Try a small variation

Use the complete case and instructions from the session Markdown.

APPLIED PRACTICE

Exercise 2: Try a small variation

- Scenario: Using the exact same PR Newswire product announcement from Exercise 1, assume your company is the direct market competitor to the announcing firm.
- Task: Write an advanced modular prompt instructing ChatGPT to act as a Director of Competitive Intelligence. Analyze the announcement to construct a 1-page "Sales Battlecard" for your sales reps containing: (1) Competitor Claim vs. Market Reality check, (2) Top 3 customer purchasing objections your reps will hear, and (3) 3 counter-arguments highlighting your product's competitive advantage.
- Deliverable: A structured, schema-compliant Sales Battlecard ready to distribute to a sales team.

Write your session report

Use Report_template.docx in Microsoft Word. Save it as FirstName_StudentID_W2_Keyword.docx and upload it to iLearn by 23:59 on class day.

SUBMIT

One report for this session

- Introduction: Describe the product launch you chose and the briefing your company needs.
- Method: Copy your 4-box prompt from Exercise 1 and your Director of Competitive Intelligence prompt from Exercise 2.
- Results: Include a 4-box table showing what you wrote for Role, Business Context, Task Directive, and Sample Output Template. Add the executive memo and the Sales Battlecard.
- Conclusion: State whether the AI followed your output structure, and one change that would make the prompt more reliable.

How to know the work is complete

Check your report before you hand it in.

VERIFY

Success check

- Receive an answer that matches professional business formats without needing to rewrite it multiple times.